# TASK 4: SEVERITY & CASE CLASSIFICATION

Pharmacovigilance Internship • Practice Worksheet

**Purpose:** Classify sample adverse drug reaction (ADR) cases by seriousness, expectedness, outcome, and clinical impact. These are **fictional practice cases** for learning only—not real patient reports.

## 1. Case Classification Overview

| Case ID | Suspected reaction | Seriousness | Expectedness | Outcome | Clinical impact |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CASE-01 | Mild itchy rash after amoxicillin | Non-serious (practice assumption) | Check against approved product information | Recovered after stopping medicine (example) | Low; no admission or major intervention described |
| CASE-02 | Severe breathing difficulty after a medicine | Serious if life-threatening / requires urgent intervention | Check against approved product information | Recovering / unknown until confirmed | High; urgent medical assessment required |
| CASE-03 | Nausea after a medicine, no treatment needed | Non-serious (practice assumption) | Check against approved product information | Recovered (example) | Low; temporary discomfort described |

## 2. Case Details & Classification Rationale

### *CASE-01 — Itchy rash following amoxicillin*

Practice scenario: A person taking amoxicillin develops an itchy rash. The rash improves after the suspected medicine is stopped. No hospital admission, disability, or life-threatening event is described.

**Seriousness:** Non-serious based on the details provided; reassess if additional serious criteria are present.
**Expectedness:** Cannot be finalized without checking the applicable approved product information / reference safety information.
**Clinical impact:** Mild-to-moderate discomfort; symptoms improve in the example scenario.
**Reasoning:** A temporal association and improvement after stopping may support assessment, but do not by themselves prove causality.

### *CASE-02 — Severe breathing difficulty after a medicine*

Practice scenario: A person develops severe breathing difficulty shortly after taking a medicine and needs urgent medical assessment.

**Seriousness:** Treat as potentially serious; life-threatening status and any admission must be confirmed from the case facts.
**Expectedness:** Check the applicable approved product information / reference safety information.
**Clinical impact:** Potentially high because urgent medical assessment is required.
**Reasoning:** Do not delay urgent care while completing a report. This example is fictional and is not medical advice for a real event.

### *CASE-03 — Nausea without additional complications*

Practice scenario: A person reports nausea after taking a medicine. No hospitalization, life-threatening event, disability, or intervention is described, and the symptom resolves.

**Seriousness:** Non-serious based on the limited details provided.
**Expectedness:** Check the applicable approved product information / reference safety information.
**Clinical impact:** Low in this example; temporary symptom that resolves.
**Reasoning:** The classification may change if new clinical details or serious criteria are identified.

## 3. Classification Fields (for recording each case)

| Field | What to record |
|---|---|
| Case ID | Unique practice case number; do not include real patient identifiers. |
| Reaction / event | Describe the reported reaction using clear, neutral wording. |
| Seriousness | Assess seriousness criteria such as death, life-threatening event, hospitalization, disability, congenital anomaly, or other medically important event. |
| Expectedness | Compare the reaction with the relevant approved product information / reference safety information. |

| Field | What to record |
|---|---|
| Outcome | Record only what is known: recovered, recovering, not recovered, recovered with sequelae, fatal, or unknown, as applicable to the form. |
| Clinical impact | Summarize symptom severity, treatment/intervention, and impact supported by the available facts. |
| Rationale / follow-up | Briefly explain the classification and list missing information that needs confirmation. |

**Important:** Seriousness and severity are not the same. Seriousness is assessed using regulatory outcome criteria; severity describes the intensity of symptoms. Expectedness requires checking the correct reference safety information. Use only verified case details for an actual submission.